Verbal Ability Sample Test
1
Directions for questions 1 to 5: In each of the following sentences, a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence, four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated.

Choose the best
alternative from among the four.
1. Amar, Binod, Chand and me were all cited for contempt of court.
(a) Amar, Binod, Chand and me were all cited
(b) Amar, Binod, Chand and I were all cited
(c) Amar, Binod, Chand and I were the ones cited
(d) Amar, Binod, Chand and I were cited

2. It is often better to try repairing an old vehicle than to junk it.
(a) to try repairing an old vehicle than to junk it.
(b) to repair an old vehicle than to have it junked.
(c) to try repairing an old vehicle than to junking
it.
(d) to try to repair an old vehicle than to junk it.

3. Vijayendra eats faster than me.
(a) Vijayendra eats faster than me.
(b) Vijayendra eats the fastest of us two.
(c) Vijayendra eats the fastest of us both.
(d) Vijayendra eats faster than I.

4. I think everybody in this office works faster than me.
(a) everybody in this office works faster than me.
(b) everybody in this office works faster than I.
(c) everybody in this office works more quickly than me.
(d) everybody in this office works more quickly than I do.

5. Neither of the two boys' explanations were satisfactory.
(a) Neither of the two boys' explanations

were
(b) Neither of the two boys' explanation
were
(c) Neither of the two boys' explanations
was
(d) Neither of the two boy's explanations
were

Directions for questions 6 to 10: Pick out the most effective pair of words from the given pair of words to make the sentence/sentences meaningfully complete.

6. Many people take spirituality very seriously and _____ about those who do not worrying about them and _____ them to believe.
(a) think, criticizing
(b) pride, appraising
(c) rationalize, enabling
(d) wonder, prodding

7. Unless new reserves are found soon, the world's supply of coal is being _____ in such a way that with demand continuing to grow at present rates reserves will be _____ by the year 2050.
(a) consumed, completed
(b) depleted, exhausted
(c) reduced, argument
(d) brunt, destroyed

8. If you are _____, you tend to respond to stressful situations, in a calm secure, steady and _____ way.
(a) resilient, rational
(b) obdurate, manageable
(c) propitious, stable
(d) delectable, flexible

9. Management can be defined as the process of _____ organizational goals and non-human resources to _____ improve value added to the world.
(a) getting, deliberately
(b) managing, purposefully
(c) targeting, critically
(d) reaching, continuously

10. If you are an introvert, you _____ to prefer working alone and, if possible, will _____ towards projects where you can work by

yourself or with as few people as possible.
(a) like, depart
(b) advocate, move
(c) tend, gravitate
(d) express, attract

Direction for questions 11: Solve these questions independently.

11. Any person who uses words ambiguously cannot become a journalist, since journalistic reporting cannot invite artistic interpretation. Which of the following, if assumed, would allow the conclusion above to be properly drawn?
(a) No person who invites artistic interpretation can use words ambiguously.
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(b) Any person who uses words ambiguously will invite artistic interpretation in their reporting.
(c) Any journalist who invites artistic interpretation will sometimes use words ambiguously.
(d) Either a journalist uses words ambiguously or that journalist invites artistic interpretation.

Directions for questions 12 to 15: There are few sentences in each question. Each sentence has pairs of words/phrases that are italicized/highlighted. From the italicized/highlighted word(s)/phrase(s), select the most appropriate word(s)/phrase(s) to form correct sentences. Then choose the best option.

12. i. The college affected [A]/effected [B] a new policy on leave encashment by teachers.
ii. The rationale [A]/rational [B] behind current curricula is that students need to learn language and thinking skills, not specific information.
(a) AA (b) BB
(c) BA (d) AB

13. i. Our confidence in cricket has been seriously undermined [A]/underrated [B] by the recent match fixing scandal.
ii. His valid [A]/vapid [B] talk failed to

impress the investors.
iii. It was so hot that he walked in the shade [A]/shadow [B] of the tree.
(a) BBA (b) ABA
(c) ABB (d) BAB

14. i. She demonstrated immanent [A]/imminent [B] good sense in her dress and behaviour.
ii. The thunder was heard immediately [A]/imminently [B] after they saw lighting.
iii. Her nervousness was obvious with her forehead damp [A]/dank [B] with perspiration.
(a) ABA (b) BBA
(c) AAA (d) BBB

15. i. The warp [A]/woof [B] of India's economic structure is still agriculture.
ii. My friend always does the opposite of [A]/to [B] what I advise him.
iii. Compact disks with prurient [A]/prudish [B] content are secretly in circulation in the assembly.
iv. He believed that the existence of god cannot be proved; he was not an atheist [A]/agnostic [B].
(a) AAAA (b) ABAA
(c) ABBB (d) BAAB

Directions for questions 16 to 19: Given below are five sentences S1, P, Q, R and S that make a paragraph. The sentences making the paragraph have been jumbled randomly, only the first sentence S1 is at its right place. Find out the correct sequence in which P, Q, R and S should follow after S1 so that a coherent and meaningful paragraph is made.

16. S1. There was a time Egypt faced economic crisis.
P. Cotton is the chief export commodity of Egypt.
Q. Foreign trade depends on cultivation of cotton on large scale.
R. It became necessary for Egypt to boost cotton crops.
S. Only by means of increasing foreign trade Egypt could survive.
(a) PQRS (b) QRPS

(c) RPSQ (d) SRQP

17. S1. Exercising daily is a must for good health.
P. Luckily, there is no link between the amount of money spent and beneficent exercise, else the poor would have creaking bodies.
Q. While some cost you nothing, others may require the investment of some amount of money.
R. However, it is important to remember that exercises should not be overdone.
S. It can take any form from sedentary ones like walking to vigorous work-outs like a game of squash.
(a) PQSR (b) QPRS
(c) RSQP (d) SQPR

18. S1. Urban problems differ from state to state and city to city.
P. Most of the cities have neither water nor the required pipelines.
Q. The population in these cities has grown beyond the planners' imagination.
R. However, certain basic problems are common to all cities.
S. Only broad macro-planning was done for such cities, without envisaging the future growth, and this has failed to meet the requirements.
(a) PQSR (b) QPSR
(c) RQSP (d) RQPS

19. S1. Satyajit Ray made several films for children.
P. Later film-makers have followed his lead.
Q. Today other nations are making children's films in a big way.
R. This was at a time when no director considered children as potential audience.
S. Ray was, thus, a pioneer in the field.
(a) SQRP (b) RSQP
(c) PSQR (d) RSPQ

Directions for questions 20 and 21: Read the passage given below and solve the questions based on it.
Hindi ought to be the official language of India. There

is no reason for the government to spend money printing documents in different languages, just to cater to people who cannot read/write Hindi. The government has better ways to spend tax payers' money. People across India should read/write Hindi or learn it at the earliest.

20. Which of the following, if true, would weaken the speaker's argument the most?
(a) The government currently translates official documents into more than eighteen languages.
(b) Hindi is the most difficult language in the world to speak.
(c) Most people who travel across India learn Hindi within five years.
(d) People who are multilingual usually pay maximum taxes.

21. United Nations members contribute funds, proportionate to their population, for facilitating smooth functioning of the UN. By 2010, India, being the most populous nation on the planet, would contribute the maximum amount to the UN. Therefore, official language of United Nations should be changed to Hindi.
Which of the following is true?
(a) The point above contradicts the speaker's argument.
(b) The point above extends the speaker's argument.
(c) The point above is similar to speaker's argument.
(d) The point above concludes speaker's argument.

Directions for questions 22 to 25: Read the passage and answer the question that follows:
Though persons of any age can have cancer, recent research has shown that eating fiber rich diet may reduce risk of some types of cancer. Modern lifestyle has resulted in increased consumption of junk food that is low in fiber. We should fortify junk food with fiber.

22. "NO JUNK FOOD NO CANCER"!
(a) The statement cannot be logically inferred from the passage.
(b) The statement is a logical inference form the passage above.

(c) The passage has contradicting statements.
(d) None of the above

23. I: Cancer is a modern disease.
II: Modern lifestyle and eating habits may have increased risk of cancer.
(a) Both I and II can be logically inferred from the above passage.
(b) Neither I nor II can be logically inferred from the above passage.
(c) Only I can be logically inferred from the above passage.
(d) Only II can be logically inferred from the above passage.

24. Teenagers are best reached via their favourite pastimes and hobbies – internet, music, movies, peer groups, sports, etc. It is through these very formats they can be told of things that would be good for them in the long run – decency, patriotism, honesty, hard work, fair play, community feeling, harmony and tolerance. Being natural rebels, no teenager likes to be lectured. These values must be communicated to them in palatable ways of their own choice via their own favorite communication modes. Only then will the lessons stick.
Which of these can be derived from the passage:
(a) Everything cannot be taught in schools and colleges.
(b) Subtlety and sensitivity would help in reaching out to teenagers.
(c) Being young, teenagers tend to have short attention spans. Long term issues must be communicated in special ways, which they are attracted to.
(d) (a) and (b) both.

25. Brushing your teeth regularly, no matter which toothpaste you use, will reduce your chances of tooth decay. Scientists have concluded that, when you brush, you reduce tooth decay by removing the film of plaque that forms on teeth and gums. So, you can forget about fluorides: brush your teeth carefully and say goodbye to cavities.

Which one of the following is a criticism of the reasoning in the argument?
(a) Brushing with fluoride toothpaste has been shown to reduce tooth decay.
(b) The fact that brushing will reduce tooth decay does not show that fluorides are of no value.
(c) Few people adequately remove plaque by brushing.
(d) People have plaque on their teeth most of the time.

ANSWERS
1. (b) 2. (d) 3. (d) 4. (b) 5. (c)
6. (d) 7. (b) 8. (a) 9. (d) 10. (c)
11. (b) 12. (a) 13. (b) 14. (c) 15. (d)
16. (d) 17. (d) 18. (d) 19. (d) 20. (d)
21. (b) 22. (b) 23. (c) 24. (d) 25. (b)